

The document "Baptism, Infant.docx" discusses the topic of infant baptism from a religious perspective, primarily focusing on biblical interpretations. Here's a summary of the key points:

Do Babies That Die Go to Heaven?

- The document suggests that babies who die go to heaven, citing verses like Luke 18:15-17 ("of such is the kingdom of God") and Isaiah 11:6-9 ("a little child shall lead them").
- It also references Isaiah 65:17-25, which describes a future where babies will no longer die young, implying a place of peace and joy.

Infant Baptism?

- **Arguments in Favor (and Rebuttals):** The document acknowledges the argument that baptism was administered to "households" in the Bible (Acts 16:15, 16:30-34, 1 Corinthians 1:16), implying that babies might have been present. However, it counters this by stating that this is mere speculation and lacks evidence.

- **Infants Lack Requirements:** It argues that infants cannot meet the requirements for baptism, which include hearing the gospel, believing, and repenting. This is compared to the legal age for getting a driver's license.

- **Faith Necessary:** The document emphasizes that faith is necessary for baptism, citing verses like Acts 8:36-38, 18:8, and 19:4-5.

- **Confession and Repentance Necessary:** It also states that confession of sin (Matthew 3:6) and repentance (Acts 2:38) are necessary for baptism, which infants cannot do.

- **"Much Water":** The document points out that baptism involved "much water" (John 3:23, Acts 8:36-39, 10:47), suggesting immersion.

- **Origin of Infant Baptism:** It claims that infant baptism did not originate with the Apostles but rather traced back to Irenaeus around 200 AD and gained prominence in the 5th

century with Augustine. It cites Mark 7:9, suggesting that infant baptism is a tradition of men rather than a commandment of God.

● **Associated Dogmas:** The document criticizes what it calls "false dogmas" associated with infant baptism, such as:

- Original sin leading to the condemnation of unbaptized babies.
- The idea that only certain churches can baptize.
- The idea that only certain clergy can baptize.

- The idea that sprinkling constitutes baptism.
- **Further Study:** It provides additional verses for further study on the topic.

Age of Accountability

- **Age 20 in Israel:** The document states that a person was considered an adult in Israel at age 20, citing various verses from Numbers, Ezra, Leviticus, and 1 Chronicles. This age was associated with serving in the temple, fighting in war, and paying atonement offerings.

- **Implications for Baptism:** It suggests that the concept of an "age of accountability" implies that baptism should not take place among children who have not matured enough to fully realize the seriousness of repentance and a changed life. It also notes that those under 20 were not held accountable for the sins that barred adults from the Promised Land.

In summary, the document presents a perspective that is critical of infant baptism, arguing that it lacks biblical support and that infants do not meet the necessary requirements for baptism, such as faith, repentance, and confession of sin. It also introduces the concept of an "age of accountability" based on the practices in ancient Israel.

DO BABIES THAT DIE GO TO HEAVEN?

Of such is the kingdom of God.

Luke 18:15-17. And **they brought unto him also infants**, that he would touch them: but when *his* disciples saw *it*, they rebuked them. But Jesus called them *unto him*, and said, **Suffer little children to come unto me, and forbid them not: for of such is the kingdom of God**. Verily I say unto you, Whosoever shall not receive the kingdom of God as a little child shall in no wise enter therein.

A little child shall lead them.

Isaiah 11:6-9 The wolf also shall dwell with the lamb, and the leopard shall lie down with the kid; and the calf and the young lion and the fatling together; and **a little child shall lead them**. And the cow and the bear shall feed; their young ones shall lie down together: and the lion shall eat straw like the ox. And **the sucking child shall play on the hole of the asp, and the weaned child shall put his hand on the cockatrice' den. They shall not hurt nor destroy in all my holy mountain:** for the earth shall be full of the knowledge of the LORD, as the waters cover the sea.

No longer will babies die.

Isaiah 65:17-25 (New Living Translation). “Look! I am creating new heavens and a new earth, and no one will even think about the old ones anymore. Be glad; rejoice forever in my creation! And look! I will create Jerusalem as a place of happiness. Her people will be a source of joy. I will rejoice over Jerusalem and delight in my people. And the sound of weeping and crying will be heard in it no more. **“No longer will babies die when only a few days old. No longer will adults die before they have lived a full life. No longer will people be considered old at one hundred!** Only the cursed will die that young! In those days people will live in the houses they build and eat the fruit of their own vineyards. Unlike the past, invaders will not take their

houses and confiscate their vineyards. For my people will live as long as trees, and my chosen ones will have time to enjoy their hard-won gains. They will not work in vain, and their children will not be doomed to misfortune. For they are people blessed by the LORD, and their children, too, will be blessed. I will answer them before they even call to me. While they are still talking about their needs, I will go ahead and answer their prayers! The wolf and the lamb will feed together. The lion will eat hay like a cow. But the snakes will eat dust. In those days no one will be hurt or destroyed on my holy mountain. I, the LORD, have spoken!"

Infant Baptism?

The argument used in Favor of.

Administered to Households

Assumes Babies Were Present. Mere Speculation, Lacks Evidence

Acts 16:15. And when she was baptized, and **her household**, she Besought us, saying, If ye have judged me to be Faithful to the Lord, come into my house, and abide there. And she constrained us.

Acts 16:30-34. And brought them out, and said, Sirs, what must I do to be saved? And they said, Believe on the Lord Jesus Christ, and thou shalt be saved, **and thy house**. And **they spake unto him the word of the Lord, and to all that were in his house**. And he took them the same hour of the night, and washed *their* stripes; and was baptized, he and all his, straightway. And **when he had brought them into his house**, he set meat before them, and rejoiced, believing in God with all his house.

1 Corinthians 1:16. And **I baptized** also **the household of** Stephanas: besides, I know not whether I baptized any other.

Infants Lack the Requirements for Baptism.

For the same reason that infants cannot get their driver's license (they do not meet the minimum legal age of 16), the law of Christ requires that one first hear the gospel, believe, and repent.

Faith Necessary To.

Acts 8:36-38. And as they went on *their* way, they came unto a certain water: and the eunuch said, **See, here is water; what doth hinder me to be baptized?** And Philip said, **If thou believest with all thine heart, thou mayest. And he answered and said, I believe that Jesus Christ is the Son of God**. And he commanded the chariot to stand still: and they went down

both into the water, both Philip and the eunuch; and **he baptized him**.

Acts 18:8. And Crispus, the chief ruler of the synagogue, believed on the Lord with all his house; and many of the Corinthians **hearing believed, and were baptized**.

Acts 19:4-5. Then said Paul, John verily baptized with the baptism of repentance, saying unto the people, that **they should believe on him which should come after him, that is, on Christ Jesus**. When they heard *this*, they were baptized in the name of the Lord Jesus.

Confession Of Sin Necessary To.

Matthew 3:6. And were **baptized of him in Jordan, confessing their sins**.

Repentance Necessary To.

Acts 2:38. Then Peter said unto them, **Repent**, and be baptized every one of you in the name of Jesus Christ for the remission of sins, and ye shall receive the gift of the Holy Ghost.

“Much Water,” The Outward And Visible Sign In.

1 Corinthians 10:2. And were all baptized unto Moses in the cloud **and in the sea**;

John 3:23. And John also was baptizing in AEnon near to Salim, because there was much water there; and they came, and were baptized.

Acts 8:36-39. And as they went on *their way*, **they came unto a certain water**: and the eunuch said, See, *here is water*; what doth hinder me to be baptized? And Philip said, If thou believest with all thine heart, thou mayest. And he answered and said, I believe that Jesus Christ is the Son of God. And he commanded the chariot to stand still: and they went down both into the water, both Philip and the eunuch; and **he baptized him**. And when they were come up out of the water, the Spirit of the Lord caught away Philip, that the eunuch saw him no more: and he went on his way rejoicing.

Acts 10:47. **Can any man forbid water**, that these should not be baptized, which have received the Holy Ghost as well as we?

Infant Baptism did not originate with the Apostles; rather, its origins trace back to Irenaeus

circa 200 AD and did not take a stronghold within Christendom until the 5th century during the time of Augustine.

*And he said unto them, **Full well ye reject the commandment of God, that ye may keep your own tradition.** Mark 7:9*

Associated Dogmas of Infant Baptism.

- **False Dogma #1, Original Sin.** Which falsely teaches that babies not baptized by the Roman Catholic Church are judged and condemned to hell by Adam's sin,
- **False Dogma #2.** Which falsely teaches the Roman Catholic Church is the only church that can Baptize. Eastern Orthodox, Churches of Christ, etc., teach the same thing about their churches.
- **False Dogma #3.** Which falsely teaches that only a Roman Catholic priest can be baptized. Again, Eastern Orthodox, Churches of Christ, etc. teach the same thing about their churches: Bishops, elders, and ministers.
- **False Dogma #4.** Which falsely teaches sprinkling an infant constitutes an authentic baptism, ignoring insurmountable obstacles such as babies cannot hear or believe the Gospel (death, burial & resurrection of Christ), repent, confess their sins, or call on the name of Jesus Christ.

For Further Study

Colossians 2:8. Beware lest any man spoil you through philosophy and vain deceit, after the tradition of men, after the rudiments of the world, and not after Christ.

Matthew 3:16. And Jesus, when he was baptized, went up straightway out of the water: and, lo, the heavens were opened unto him, and he saw the Spirit of God descending like a dove, and lighting upon him:

Acts 8:38. And he commanded the chariot to stand still: and they went down both into the

water, both Philip and the eunuch; and he baptized him.

Acts 18:8. And Crispus, the chief ruler of the synagogue, believed on the Lord with all his house; and many of the Corinthians hearing believed, and were baptized.

Matthew 3:6. And were baptized of him in Jordan, confessing their sins.

Acts 16:30-31. And brought them out, and said, Sirs, what must I do to be saved? And they said, Believe on the Lord Jesus Christ, and thou shalt be saved, and thy house.

Acts 16:33. And he took them the same hour of the night, and washed *their* stripes; and was baptized, he and all his, straightway.

Acts 2:41. Then they that gladly received his word were baptized: and the same day there were added *unto them* about three thousand souls.

Acts 8:12. But when they believed Philip preaching the things concerning the kingdom of God, and the name of Jesus Christ, they were baptized, both men and women.

Age of Accountability

A person was considered an adult in Israel at age 20.

Numbers 14:29 Your carcasses shall fall in this wilderness; and all that were numbered of you, according to your whole number, **from twenty years old and upward**, which have murmured against me,

Numbers 32:11 Surely none of the men that came up out of Egypt, **from twenty years old and upward**, shall see the land which I swear unto Abraham, unto Isaac, and unto Jacob; because they have not wholly followed me:

At the age of 20 a person could serve in the temple.

Ezra 3:8 Now in the second year of their coming unto the house of God at Jerusalem, in the second month, began Zerubbabel the son of Shealtiel, and Jeshua the son of Jozadak, and the remnant of their brethren the priests and the Levites, and all they that were come out of the captivity unto Jerusalem; and appointed the Levites, **from twenty years old and upward**, to set forward the work of the house of the LORD.

Leviticus 27:3 And thy estimation shall be of the male **from twenty years old even unto sixty years old**, even thy estimation shall be fifty shekels of silver, after the shekel of the sanctuary.

A man was old enough to fight in war at age 20.

Numbers 26:2 Take the sum of all the congregation of the children of Israel, **from twenty years old and upward**, throughout their fathers' house, all that are able to go to war in Israel.

The age to be considered an adult in the census was 20.

Numbers 1:3 **From twenty years old and upward**, all that are able to go forth to war in Israel: thou and Aaron shall number them by their armies.

The age of Levites who served in the temple was 20.

1 Chronicles 23:24 These *were* the sons of Levi after the house of their fathers; *even* the chief of the fathers, as they were counted by number of names by their polls, that did the work for the service of the house of the LORD, **from the age of twenty years and upward**.

Those who were 20 and older had to pay ½ shekel atonement offering.

Exodus 30:14 Every one that passeth among them that are numbered, **from twenty years old and above**, shall give an offering unto the LORD.

No one 20 years of age and older was allowed into the Promised Land except for Joshua and Caleb. This shows that God did not hold those under 20 accountable for the sins that kept the adults barred from the land that represented salvation. Generally, adolescents do not have a complete grasp of the consequences of sin. This also shows that baptism should not take place among children, who have not matured enough to fully realize the seriousness of repentance and a changed life.

Numbers 32:11 Surely none of the men that came up out of Egypt, **from twenty years old and upward**, shall see the land which I sware unto Abraham, unto Isaac, and unto Jacob; because they have not wholly followed me: